The Dhāraṇī Called the Supreme Compassion

Karuṇāgra-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 913 · Derge Kangyur

སྙིང་རྗེ་མཆོག་ཅེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called the Supreme Compassion, known in Sanskrit as the Karuṇāgra nāma dhāraṇī and carrying a Tibetan title of the same meaning, is a short dhāraṇī text devoted to the bodhisattva Padmapāṇi, the lotus-bearing form of Avalokiteśvara, whose wisdom is said to arise in order to rescue beings sunk in every kind of suffering. After paying homage to the Omniscient One and to Padmapāṇi, the text presents what it calls the supreme secret mantra of the Tathāgata, the dawning of the summit of great compassion, describing it as an unobstructed and unfailing means of accomplishment that came forth from the Buddha's own mouth. Its recitation is said to pacify karmic obscurations and the sufferings of the lower realms for all beings, and to dispel harmful influences, inauspicious events, bad dreams and omens, many illnesses, and various forms of untimely death. It is Toh 913 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the class of works centered on protective and beneficial incantations.

In the language of India: karuṇa agra nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called the Supreme Compassion.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

Homage to Padmapāṇi, whose wisdom dawned in order to deliver completely the beings sunk in the thicket of every kind of suffering.

I shall explain the supreme secret mantra of the Tathāgata, the dawning of the summit of great compassion. It is the unobstructed and unfailing accomplishment of activity that came forth from the mouth of the Tathāgata. It pacifies the karmic obscurations and the many kinds of suffering of the lower realms for the entire circle of sentient beings. It thoroughly pacifies all that is harmful, everything inauspicious, all bad dreams and bad omens, many kinds of illness, and the various kinds of untimely death. It is the Great Crusher of the Thousandfold World. One should begin by first paying homage to the Blessed One, whose body is adorned with many hundred thousand koṭis of accumulations of merit.

namo bhagavate vairocanāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhaya sarva ajñāna dhakāra śamayitre tadyathā sādhani sādhani siddha viddhari bhagavati paraṃpāra kleśa dhapati ajñāna śamanī śamāya sarva pāpaṃ viśuddha dharme nirmala jñāna gocare asaṃga cariṇi praśama mūrti sukha prate sarva kleśa dhavati sarva pāpaṃ viśodhani vidhamāni vinaśāni vinaśāni vinaśāya vinaśāya bhagavati surasa vimala buddhi sara sara visara visara suru suru sūra sūra prasara prasara visara visara ajvanamakoṭi sahasra saṃcitaṃ karmaṃ āparaṇi kṣapaya kṣemavati buddha viṣāya paśavartini pāramitā jñāna gocare viśeṣavati aśeṣa malini kāruṇa gocare mahājñāna abhiṣekavati suviniścita dharme he he bhagavati mahākaruṇe kuru kuru viśodhaya maṃ sarva satvaṃ śca mahākaruṇotsekena sana siñcāya samavadhāya samabhalāya prarohāye me mahākaruṇa vijana pariśuddhaya amogha me kuru jīvitan rakṣa rakṣa māṃ bhagavati ma mahā bodhicittaṃ saṃmūhyed masantu śudviti mi karuṇi buddha bodhi prate naraka preta tirya gati duḥkhena mūlani deva manuṣya gati saṃpahana vigatopakleśe sarva buddha dharmā paripūraṇi svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī called the Supreme Great Compassion of the Blessed One. Having come forth from the crown protuberance of the Blessed One, it is accompanied by a retinue of thousands of countless dhāraṇīs. It destroys all evil deeds, all karma, and all afflictions. It pacifies everything inauspicious, all bad dreams, all bad omens, and every untimely death. It brings long life, merit, beauty, strength, happiness, eloquence, and freedom from illness. It surely destroys all the seizing spirits among the bhūtas, apasmāras, yakṣas, rākṣasas, garuḍas, asuras, and kinnaras.

Merely by holding the name of this dhāraṇī, by hearing it, or by reciting it, even the karmic obscurations accumulated over a hundred thousand koṭis of lifetimes will be cleansed. All afflictions will grow thin. All of that person's rebirths in the lower realms will be cut off. All the buddhas and bodhisattvas will take him into their care. He will be endowed with the virtue of the bodhisattvas. He will become one whose nature is never to decline. He will never fall away from compassion. All sentient beings will delight in him.

If one recites it seven times in each of the three periods of the day and the three periods of the night, one will be freed from all evil deeds and will also attain immeasurable thousands, indeed countless numbers, of the qualities of a bodhisattva.

At daybreak, one should sit comfortably in the cross-legged posture, form the triangle mudrā with the hands, and focus on all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Having visualized before one the Tathāgata, great in his qualities, one says, "Homage to the Tathāgata," and pays homage with the mind. If one then recites it twenty-one times, every wish one holds in mind will be fulfilled, and one will accomplish one's aims exactly as intended.

On the eighth, fourteenth, and fifteenth days of the month, one should make offerings to the Blessed One, take the vows of the fasting observance, and put on white clothing. Having given gifts and taken up the great awakening mind, one who is free of anything unsightly, with hands outstretched, should anoint a maṇḍala with his own hand. Having made offerings to it with flowers of three colors and censed it with white sandalwood, one should imagine all the many kinds of offerings and great honors found throughout the infinite thousands of world systems that are worthy of the tathāgatas, and offer them to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. If one then recites this heart mantra of the Tathāgata, from which the blazing Great Thousandfold arises, until great joy is born, one will know oneself to be dwelling in the presence of the tathāgatas, and will attain the joy of the tathāgatas' great enjoyment of the Dharma, untouched by material things. From then on, one is born irreversibly into the family of the Tathāgata.

Even when he passes on to another life, he will attain the great ground of a bodhisattva. He will also attain the state of a universal monarch among the great holders of vidyā-mantras. He will also attain dhāraṇī. He also brings delight to the tathāgatas. He will also attain higher knowledges that never decline. In this very life, too, all sentient beings will be pleased with him. All the gods will protect him. All the nāgas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, yakṣas, and rākṣasas will also protect him, and whomever he addresses will carry out his task. Whatever he thinks of and whatever he enjoins, the gods and the others will do. All his desires will be fulfilled. No one will contradict his words. The gods will increase his strength, beauty, merit, youth, health, and prosperity. No obstructor at all will be able to harm him.

In brief, there are those who wish to enter the city of the tathāgatas, those who wish to see the great buddha body of the tathāgatas, and those who wish to attain every excellent quality. There are also those who wish to take up the role of a person in training in the precepts of the great bodhisattvas, and those who wish to obtain the commitment of the nature of reality of the great bodhisattvas. There are those who wish to realize the true nature of the great tantra constantly, unceasingly, and without interruption, and those who wish to adorn themselves with the ornament of the tathāgatas' qualities. In order to gather a great accumulation of qualities, all of them should first, with great diligence and keeping all the tathāgatas in mind, take up this dhāraṇī, which the tathāgatas praise and on which the bodhisattva great beings properly rely, in accordance with the rite exactly as it has been taught.

This completes the dhāraṇī called The Supreme Compassion.

Translator's Notes

- "The Great Crusher of the Thousandfold World" renders [illegible]. This is the standard Tibetan for Mahāsāhasrapramardanī, the name of one of the five protective dhāraṇīs (Pañcarakṣā). Here it is phrased verbally and appears to be used as an epithet of this mantra, so it is translated rather than given as the Sanskrit title. The later phrase "from which the blazing Great Thousandfold arises" echoes it, but its exact sense is uncertain.

In that later passage, [illegible] means the heart mantra (hṛdaya) of the Tathāgata, not buddha-nature in the doctrinal sense.

The phrase [illegible], "free of anything unsightly, with hands outstretched," describes the one who anoints the maṇḍala. It is obscure, and the rendering is tentative.

[illegible] is rendered as the name Padmapāṇi, the form of Avalokiteśvara who holds a lotus.
- "The great tantra" renders [illegible]. In this context the word could also mean "the great continuum," that is, the mindstream or the continuity of practice. "Keeping all the tathāgatas in mind" takes [illegible] as describing how one takes up the dhāraṇī. It could also be read as part of the name of the rite: "the rite of contemplating all the tathāgatas."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.